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Catalog Assignment
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Our cohort has discussed Ohlone College's vision and goals extensively. In addition, Ohlone College is embarking on a new vision as a Learning College. They read as follows:

Vision Statement

Ohlone College will be known throughout California for our inclusiveness, innovation, and superior rates of student success.

Core Values

- We provide lifelong learning opportunities for students, college personnel, and the community.
- We open access to higher education and actively reach out to underserved populations.
- We promote diversity, inclusiveness, and openness to differing viewpoints.
- We maintain high standards in our constant pursuit of excellence.
- We value trust, respect, and integrity.
- We promote teamwork and open communication.
- We practice innovation and actively encourage risk-taking and entrepreneurship.
- We demonstrate stewardship for our human, financial, physical, and environmental resources.

College Goals

1. Promote appreciation for and understanding of diverse races and cultures by expanding the diversity of college personnel, international education offerings and exchanges, cross-cultural curricula, and ethnic/cultural events.
2. Develop across the curriculum the Learning College Model, utilizing methods and technologies that hold the most promise for improving student course and program completion success rates.
3. Develop strategies to increase the proportion of full-time students, including learning communities, cohort groups, enhanced facilities, and improved course availability.
4. Provide continuous learning for all personnel associated with the district and promote an organizational structure that is adaptable, collegial, and supportive of the Learning College Model.
5. Promote the health, environmental, cultural, and economic vitality of the communities served by the district through programs of outreach, community services, and partnership ventures.

6. Promote and maintain an accessible, clean, safe, and healthy college environment through continuous engagement of students and college personnel in campus preparedness, wellness, beautification, and environmental sustainability.
7. Increase public and private funds for educational programs, equipment, and facilities through entrepreneurial activities, grants, and the college foundation.

Most important area

Learning College, as defined by O'Banion (1997), is a new educational model that seeks to create an institution designed to help students make passionate connections to learning. The model is based on the assumption that educational experiences are designed for learners' convenience rather than for the convenience of institutions and their staff. In the college learning paradigm, all stakeholders pursue lifelong learning and commit to innovation, creativity, and risk-taking.

Examples of your experience with implementation

To accomplish these aims, over the past year, Ohlone College has launched the Learning Communities initiative, a major transformation in how the college approaches teaching and learning. Learning communities intentionally restructure the curriculum to bring students, faculty, and disciplines together in more integrated and meaningful ways.

Analysis of these experiences

Change to a learning college model contributes to the transformation of the culture of higher education. Essentially, it is a blueprint for formal expectations and learning outcomes. However, the definition of learning college is somewhat ambiguous and thus has different meanings for each person depending on one's role in the organization.

There is a clear need for a formal structure for accommodating both collective goals and individual differences. Learning college models can occur only when goals, roles, and responsibilities are clearly defined.

Hard to meet areas

Ohlone College is a Professional Organization, but it functions as a Machine Bureaucracy. It has highly specialized, routine operating tasks; formalized procedures as its operating core; a proliferation of rules and regulations; formalized communication throughout the organization; relatively centralized decision-making power; and an elaborate administrative structure with sharp distinctions between line and staff. This type of top-down structure is typical of a community college configuration with management presiding over "silos" within the organization. To change, we need to determine what is working, what is not working (and why), and restructure accordingly.

I wish to begin these comments with a focus on terms: From readings about community development (Senge, 1990) and a review of the Ohlone College Mission statement, "Community" is defined as a group of people who:

- Share and agree on an articulated common purpose

- Interact on a regular basis
- Hold each other accountable for agreed-upon values and behaviors
- Are inclusive of differences